BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Thursday 22 Oct 2026, 07:50 Malaysia time (23:50 UTC, 21 Oct)

BTC ~ $84,300

CoinGecko/Coinbase: +1.7-1.9% 24h, +3.4% 7d

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral to mildly bullish	**Next 24h range:** $82,600 - $85,900 (1-sigma)	**Key floor:** $82,500 (24h low / 20-day EMA)	**Big event:** FOMC 29 Oct 2:00am MYT; $12B monthly expiry 30 Oct

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

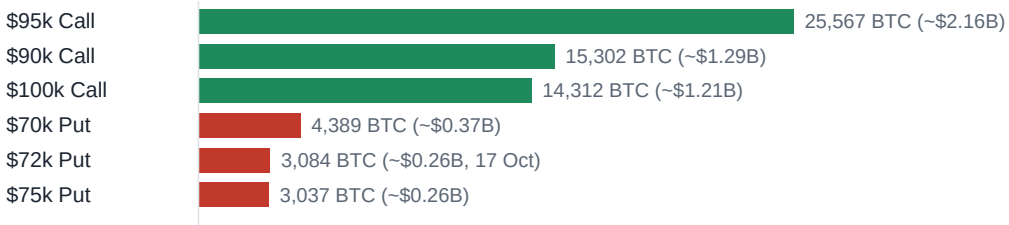
- **Next expiry:** Deribit daily 22OCT26 settles today **4:00pm MYT** (08:00 UTC). Daily expiries are small; no published size this run.
- **Weekly 23OCT26** (Fri 4:00pm MYT, ~32h away): about **$1.23B notional** (Bitfinex; CryptoTicker counted 14,759 BTC on 17 Oct), **max pain ~$82,000**, about 2.7% below spot.
- **The expiry that matters is the 30 Oct monthly**: ~148,600 BTC (~$12.5B at spot), put/call 0.50, max pain $78-79k, a massive call stack at $90k-$100k. It settles two days after the FOMC.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
22OCT26 daily (today 4pm)	Not readable this run	Small (daily)	Too small to move price on its own; settlement-hour noise only.
23OCT26 weekly (Fri 4pm)	Total book; max pain $82k	~$1.23B notional	Mild pull toward $82-84k into Friday; strike detail not published.
30OCT26 monthly - call	$95,000 Call	25,567 BTC (~$2.16B)	Biggest single position; upside magnet only if $90k is reached.
30OCT26 monthly - put	$70,000 Put	4,389 BTC (~$0.37B)	Crash insurance; far below spot, little effect now.

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Thu 22 Oct, 4:00pm (daily)	n/a	n/a	n/a	Not published
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.23B	n/a	~$82,000	Not published
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$12.5B (148,585 BTC)	0.50	$78,000-79,000	Calls $95k / $90k / $100k; puts $70k / $72k / $75k
Fri 25 Dec, 4:00pm (quarterly)	n/a	n/a	~$75,000 (Deribit, 10 Oct)	n/a

Deribit 30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry - largest open interest by strike (BTC)



How options affect the market now

- **Pinned in $82k-$85k:** PANews reports large dealer positions across $82k-$85k; hedging means dealers sell roughly 1,500 BTC per 1% rally there. That explains four failed breaks of $84k since 11 Oct and makes $85k a sticky lid.
- **If $85.3k breaks:** the hedging lid weakens and short liquidation clusters at $85.3-85.5k and $86.2k can accelerate a move toward $86.5-87.2k.
- **Max pain pulls lower:** weekly max pain ~$82k and monthly $78-79k sit below spot, a mild downward drift into the Friday and 30 Oct settlements if momentum fades.

- **Sentiment split:** open interest is call-heavy (monthly P/C 0.50), but recent flow leaned to puts: 24h put volume was more than double calls on 21 Oct, with the 30 Oct $80k put the most traded. Traders are bullish on paper but buying protection.
- **Volatility is cheap:** DVOL ~37-38 (near 5-year lows) versus 14-day realized ~20%. Compressed volatility into FOMC usually ends with a sharp expansion; the direction is unknown.
- **Size check:** today's daily and Friday's $1.2B weekly are too small to drive the trend; the $12B 30 Oct book is the real gravity.

Data note: the Deribit public API (index, DVOL, book summary) could not be read this run, so options figures come from published reports (CryptoTicker 17/20 Oct, Bitfinex via crypto.news 21 Oct, PANews 21 Oct). USD sizes = OI x ~$84,300. Treat strikes as largest seen, not a full book.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC rallied from ~$81,200 on 20 Oct to a 24h high of ~$84,800-84,900 on 21 Oct, its highest since late January, on a tech-earnings rally (SpaceX beat) and renewed ETF inflows.
- It is now ~$84,300, holding just above the $84,000 level that capped four rallies since 11 Oct. A daily close above it is the first test of whether the range is breaking.
- Short liquidations drove the move ($250M of $327M total in 24h). Open interest rose ~5.5% against a ~2.8% price gain, so new long leverage is building quickly.
- Daily RSI ~58 (not overbought); Bollinger bands are tight at ~$80.3k-$86.3k, a classic pre-breakout squeeze.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$86,200 - 87,200	Liquidation cluster at $86.2k; Ali Charts target $86.5k; 20-day high $87,220; upper Bollinger $86.3k.
Resistance 1	$84,900 - 85,500	24h high and range lid; options hedging wall; short liquidation cluster at $85.3-85.5k.
Pivot	$84,000	Four failed breakouts since 11 Oct; holding above it turns old resistance into support.
Support 1	$83,400 - 82,500	Rekt Capital $83.4k must hold; 20-day EMA ~$82.6k and 24h low $82.6k; long liquidations $82.2-82.5k.
Support 2	$82,000	Weekly (23 Oct) max pain.
Deep risk	$80,700 - 78,000	50-day EMA $80.7k, range floor $79.8-80k, monthly max pain $78-79k, 100-day EMA $77.2k.

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures open interest	~$67.1B aggregate perps	Rising (+3.4% to +5.5% d/d per Ted Pillows); new longs chasing.
Funding (8h)	+0.0079%	Barely positive; leverage not yet stretched.
Liquidations (24h)	$327M, of which $250M shorts	A short squeeze fuelled the push to $84.8k.
Long/short ratio	1.63	Long-tilted; adds flush risk if $82.5k fails.
Spot BTC ETF flows	+$526.7M (19 Oct), +$23.2M (20 Oct), +$60.0M (21 Oct, IBIT pending)	Three straight inflow days; October net now about -$7M (est.), close to flipping positive.
DVOL (30-day IV)	~37-38	Near 5-year lows; implied daily move ~2.0% (~$1,650).
Fear and Greed (CFGI)	57 Neutral (21 Oct)	Greed rising but not euphoric.
CME futures OI	~110,000 BTC	About 17% of total; institutions engaged.

4. News and macro

- **Risk-on tech:** S&P 500 +0.58% to 7,757 (near record), Nasdaq +1.05% on 21 Oct. Meta +3.3% after hours on a strong Q4 outlook; Tesla flat after hours. A SpaceX-Tesla merger is being explored that would combine 30,000+ BTC.
- **Fed:** blackout until the 27-28 Oct FOMC. After the September hike to 3.75-4.00%, Kalshi prices 88% hold and 11% hike. September CPI was 3.7% y/y; the 10-year yield is 5.13%, with the 2-year at 4.81%.
- **Oil and geopolitics:** Brent $108.8 (above $110 intraday). Iran says there is little reason to expect progress on Hormuz talks; Putin hosted US envoy Witkoff and offered to mediate. High oil keeps inflation and hike risk alive.
- **Regulation:** the OCC finalized its GENIUS Act stablecoin rule on 21 Oct (effective 18 Jan 2027; no yield for simply holding). FINMA approved Switzerland's first retail spot BTC ETF; Grayscale expanded in-kind subscriptions.
- **Flows:** IBIT's $665M on 19 Oct was its biggest day since October 2025, but ETH ETFs have had five straight days of outflows (-$388.9M over 5 sessions).

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Thu 22 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit daily options expiry
Thu 22 Oct, 8:30pm	US initial jobless claims
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit weekly expiry (~$1.23B, max pain ~$82k)
Fri 23 Oct, 9:45pm / 10:00pm	S&P Global flash Oct PMIs / UMich final Oct sentiment
Sun 25 Oct	Brazil presidential runoff
Thu 29 Oct, 2:00am (2:30am presser)	FOMC rate decision (Wed 28 Oct, 2pm ET)
Thu 29 Oct, 8:30pm	US Q3 GDP (advance) + September PCE inflation
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit monthly expiry (~$12.5B, max pain $78-79k)
Wed 4 Nov (US 3 Nov)	US midterm elections; October jobs and CPI dates to be confirmed

5. Summary and prediction

Bitcoin finally pushed through the top of its $80k-$84k October range on short covering, three days of ETF inflows and a risk-on tech tape. It now sits at the options 'wall' where dealer hedging has repeatedly sold rallies. Funding is still flat and volatility is very cheap, so a squeeze through $85.3k is possible. Against that, open interest is climbing faster than price, and both max-pain levels ($82k weekly, $78-79k monthly) sit below spot, which favours a stall or a dip before the Fed. Macro is not clean: 5%+ yields, $108 Brent and an 11% hike risk cap enthusiasm. **24h call: range $83,000-$85,300 with a slight upward lean; a daily close above $85,300 opens $86.5-87.2k, while losing $82,500 targets $81-82k.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range/pin	50%	$83,000 - 85,300	Dealer hedging caps $85k; dips into $83.4k bought; quiet claims data.
Bullish breakout	25%	$85,300 - 87,200	Hourly/daily close above $85.3k, more ETF inflows (IBIT), Nasdaq follow-through on Meta; short liquidations at $85.5k/$86.2k.
Bearish flush	25%	$81,200 - 82,800	Rejection at $84.9k, loss of $82.5k triggers long liquidations; oil spike or yields higher; drift to $82k max pain.

- Breakout signal: hourly close above $85,300 with rising spot volume and funding staying below 0.01%; breakdown signal: a 4h close below $82,500.
- IBIT figure for 21 Oct and the 22 Oct ETF print; jobless claims at 8:30pm MYT; Brent above $110 is a risk-off warning.
- Next report: 3:50pm MYT (Thu 22 Oct).

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